

**CV-24-010016 REEVES, MARNIE ANN vs RENNER, JEREMY LEE –
Defendant’s Motion for Summary Judgment on the First Amended
Complaint, in its Entirety, or in the Alternative, Summary Adjudication of
the First, Second and Third Causes of Action of the First Amended
Complaint – GRANTED in full.**

County: stanislaus

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: 21

Hearing date: 2012-04-02

Motion: Objections to the Reeves Declaration: 1-18: All objections are OVERRULED. The declaration is accepted only for the specific facts and not the conclusions from those facts. The hearsay objections as to things Renner is alleged to have said are not well taken, as they are either not hearsay, an alleged statement by the party opponent, or both. 19-35, 38-42: OVERRULED, except as to assertions that Meta AI or Truthfinder are accurate statements of whether a person is Renner-associated. Reeves describes the items and provided signed declarations under penalty of perjury; I disbelieve any technical deficiencies are sufficient to not consider the declarations. (I note that Reeves substantially followed the rules governing this motion, which are not intuitive, and Renner very promptly repaired a technical deficiency in his filing when the Court called attention to it.) 36-37: SUSTAINED. Factual Summary Marnie Reeves, the Plaintiff, engaged with multiple people claiming to be the actor Jeremy Renner, related to Jeremy Renner, or Jeremy Renner’s management team over a period of time both before and after filing this lawsuit. Various Renners would tell her that the other Renners were scammers, but he was the real Jeremy Renner. Reeves sent money to many people, including people in Colorado, France, and to unknown bitcoin wallets. The text messages (see, for instance, Exhibit 40) regularly have a person identifying as Renner professing a desire to maintain a romantic relationship with Reeves, and asking for money. Accounts like “PrivateJeremmyR” contacted her and she engaged these accounts. She paid for a meet and greet at the Hotel Per La in Los Angeles. This was arranged via a “Lasse Larsson,” who gave strict instructions to lie to the bank about the wire transfer and to assert it was for family. The money was wired to a “Jen Joiner.” The letter she received from (ostensibly) the hotel said her confirmation number was 7, that she was in room 7, and spelled “Address” incorrectly. The letter is not on any specialized stationery and appears to be a Word document with uneven capitalization. Reeves believes a song by Renner, “Wait,” is Renner singing about her. Reeves eventually had at least seven emails for Renner, and additionally believed multiple other people were working with Renner, including an account from “J. Renner Inc.” Reeves asserts that Renner changed the contact information to a person who wasn’t him. The registered owner of the company is “James Arnol Renner.” (I note here that, like all claims in this case from social media accounts, the actual source of the J. Renner Inc. account is unknown.) Reeves purchased a “fan card” which misspells her name and has some irregular capitalization. Reeves spoke to an account ostensibly run by Renner’s mother who said the other Jeremy Renner(s) were frauds but that her son wanted to talk to Reeves. Reeves asserts that she had a video call with Jeremy Renner on August 28, 2023. The specific claim is, “Defendant was in his car driving to the store per the Plaintiff and Defendant’s conversation, his phone was to the left of him, and he said, ‘I just called to say hi and how are you doing today.’ The video call was very clear and I could see him and a parking lot he was pulling into. He looked at me front view at least 3 times during the conversation. Plaintiff knew then she was safe to send the additional payments after August 2023.” Reeves engaged with a Renner as late as September 2025 and indicated she still wanted to pursue a relationship and alternatively that she was angry with him for his failures. She alleged to a Renner that he was fake because he did not know of this lawsuit. This case was filed on December 13, 2024, and a demurrer was filed by Renner in February, 2025. Renner’s Claims Renner filed a declaration saying that he never had the phone number attributable to many of the contacts with Reeves, he did not ask for any money from her, he did not receive any money from her, he did not have anything to do with any of the many social media accounts and emails that contacted Reeves, and that he was entirely disconnected with Reeves except for one meeting at a Sweet Grass Vodka event in which they had no substantive conversation. Renner also provides evidence that he has attempted to deter fans from falling for romance scams. Renner asserts incorrectly that no celebrity would charge money for a meet and greet. (See, for instance, <https://www.weirdal.com/vip-package-faqs/> (page accessed July 8, 2026.)) The Court also rejects Renner’s conclusion that this was a single scammer or a single group of scammers. Governing Law A “party moving for summary judgment bears an initial burden of production to make a prima facie showing of the nonexistence of any triable issue of material fact” (Aguilar v. Atlantic Richfield Co. (2001) 25 Cal.4th 826, 850.) “A prima facie showing is one sufficient to support the position of the party in question.” (Id. at p. 851.) A defendant meets their burden of showing that a cause of action has no merit if the party shows that “one or more elements of the cause of action, even if not separately pleaded, cannot be established, or that there is a complete defense to the cause of action.” (Code Civ. Proc., § 437c(p)(2).) Once the defendant meets that burden, the burden shifts to the plaintiff, who must show that “a triable issue of one or more material facts exists as to the cause of

action or a defense thereto.” (Ibid.) “Because of the drastic nature of the summary judgment procedure and the importance of safeguarding the adverse party’s right to a trial, the moving party must make a strong showing. His affidavits are strictly construed and the opposing party’s are liberally construed.” (Garcia v. World Savings, FSB (2010) 183 Cal.App.4th 1031, 1038.) All doubts as to whether any material, triable issues of fact exist are to be resolved in favor of the party opposing summary judgment or adjudication. (Barber v. Marina Sailing, Inc. (1995) 36 Cal.App.4th 558, 562.) Thus, evidence that is equivocal or from which conflicting inferences may be drawn is insufficient to meet the movant’s burden. (Anderson v. Metalclad Insulation Corp. (1999) 72 Cal.App.4th 284, 297.) In addition to moving for summary judgment, “[a] party may move for summary adjudication as to one or more causes of action within an action, one or more affirmative defenses, one or more claims for damages, or one or more issues of duty, if that party contends that the cause of action has no merit or that there is no affirmative defense thereto, or that there is no merit to an affirmative defense as to any cause of action, or both, or that there is no merit to a claim for damages, as specified in Section 3294 of the Civil Code, or that one or more defendants either owed or did not owe a duty to the plaintiff or plaintiffs.” (Code Civ. Proc., § 437c(f)(1).) A motion for summary adjudication proceeds in all procedural respects as a motion for summary judgment. (Code Civ. Proc., § 437c(f)(2).) Analysis Renner has met the first hurdle. His clear disclaiming of any of the social media contacts and of any ownership of the emails, phone numbers, or businesses is sufficient to shift the burden to Reeves to show that the people she sent money to were Renner or agents of Renner. Reeves clearly has competent evidence that she has made payments to multiple people and certainly has enough evidence that she intended to form a relationship with Renner. But Reeves’ factual disputes are insufficient. In UMF’s 66-75, Renner disclaims any knowledge of the individuals Reeves sent money to – Julie Parsons, Mythe Thien Nguyen Dinh, Dorie Nichols, and Mle Michovska Mihaela. Reeves says Renner was aware of these people, but the basis for that is that Renner told her to send the money to these people, and in some cases there are tenuous connections to them via website or (assertedly) AI searches. The web searches are not evidence, and the remainder is entirely speculative. Reeves assert that she was contacted via many different phone numbers on WhatsApp. She cites the following text from August 1, 2025: “I understand we talked before, then all of the sudden I could not access my telegram anymore, then by that time I gained full access to it, this whole stuff has already taken place, I was so confused. I do feel it’s some one in my circle.” Reeves analysis is: “This is not how imposters act or say.” This analysis is not compelling. Celebrities are not immune from committing crimes of all sorts. Renner’s celebrity status provides him no immunity from ordinary summary judgment analysis. Renner’s celebrity status does provide motive for scammers to imitate him though, and the manner in which this was done does not reflect a well-oiled entertainment management organization as Reeves alleges. The phone call Reeves asserts that she made a video phone call in which she saw the “front” of Renner three times in August, 2023. Under Code Civ. Proc. section 437c(e), the Court may not determine credibility unless the matter is so incredible as a matter of law as not to be believed. Inferences from facts however may be made. I assume that the phone call occurred. This was the linchpin allegation that brought this case past the demurrer stage. This was also the closest portion of this ruling, and I have carefully considered the allegation. Reeves said Renner “looked” at her, implying but not directly asserting that she saw his face. But Reeves provides no evidence of control over the phone. The call, as described, has a driving “Renner” not viewable by Reeves except when he looked at the phone three times while driving. Even if she saw his face, the alleged ratification of prior contacts would very strongly indicate this was not the actual Jeremy Renner; I have tried to give the flavor of the contacts, and there are no remaining signs that the actual person Jeremy Renner had anything to do with any of this. Reeves also expressed doubts before and after the phone call, including months after Renner had appeared in this case. Reeves herself seems unpersuaded that this evidence was dispositive. Further, in People v. Schlimbach (2011) 193 Cal.App.4th 1132, fn6, an appellate court found that the Court may determine as a matter of law that a factual assertion is not credible under unusual circumstances. In that case, the assertion that a person with a 0.24% blood alcohol might appear to be intoxicated when he was not, and that another had a speech impediment which the officer mistook for being under the influence. This obviously is not impossible, but was of sufficiently remote probability that the appellate court found it to be facially incredible and that a trial court would be within its rights to ignore it. Conclusion There is virtually no evidence that Renner got the money or asked for the money, and the evidence is insufficient to tie him to the phone call. If this were a beyond-a-reasonable-doubt standard, Renner is not liable beyond a reasonable doubt, and probably by the higher standard of criminal factual innocence. I note here that this case has used substantial resources of the court and counsel. I would caution the legislature not to impose a cure worse than the problem; this case has doubtless been vexing to Renner (and surely to Reeves, who appears to still believe the actor stole her money). Lawsuits against people who did nothing wrong are expensive and taxing; California’s efforts to reduce them – as by anti-SLAPP rules – have been laudable. The Court will sign the proposed order. Defendant is to prepare a judgment consistent with this ruling.

Source URL: <https://www.stanislaus.courts.ca.gov/online-services/tentative-rulings/civil-tentative-rulings>

Source SHA-256: 8eb6f104fd9fde2390c75d48581f97b8223a18090b14ff38362705c003d9b3cf

CV-24-010016 – REEVES, MARNIE ANN vs RENNER, JEREMY LEE – Defendant’s Motion for Summary Judgment on the First Amended Complaint, in its Entirety, or in the Alternative, Summary Adjudication of the First, Second and Third Causes of Action of the First Amended Complaint – GRANTED in full.

Objections to the Reeves Declaration:

1-18: All objections are OVERRULED. The declaration is accepted only for the specific facts and not the conclusions from those facts. The hearsay objections as to things Renner is alleged to have said are not well taken, as they are either not hearsay, an alleged statement by the party opponent, or both.

19-35, 38-42: OVERRULED, except as to assertions that Meta AI or Truthfinder are accurate statements of whether a person is Renner-associated. Reeves describes the items and provided signed declarations under penalty of perjury; I disbelieve any technical deficiencies are sufficient to not consider the declarations. (I note that Reeves substantially followed the rules governing this motion, which are not intuitive, and Renner very promptly repaired a technical deficiency in his filing when the Court called attention to it.)

36-37: SUSTAINED.

Factual Summary

Marnie Reeves, the Plaintiff, engaged with multiple people claiming to be the actor Jeremy Renner, related to Jeremy Renner, or Jeremy Renner's management team over a period of time both before and after filing this lawsuit.

Various Renners would tell her that the other Renners were scammers, but he was the real Jeremy Renner. Reeves sent money to many people, including people in Colorado, France, and to unknown bitcoin wallets.

The text messages (see, for instance, Exhibit 40) regularly have a person identifying as Renner professing a desire to maintain a romantic relationship with Reeves, and asking for money.

Accounts like "PrivateJeremmyR" contacted her and she engaged these accounts.

She paid for a meet and greet at the Hotel Per La in Los Angeles. This was arranged via a "Lasse Larsson," who gave strict instructions to lie to the bank about the wire transfer and to assert it was for family. The money was wired to a "Jen Joiner."

The letter she received from (ostensibly) the hotel said her confirmation number was 7, that she was in room 7, and spelled "Address" incorrectly. The letter is not on any specialized stationery and appears to be a Word document with uneven capitalization.

Reeves believes a song by Renner, "Wait," is Renner singing about her.

Reeves eventually had at least seven emails for Renner, and additionally believed multiple other people were working with Renner, including an account from "J. Renner Inc." Reeves asserts that Renner changed the contact information to a person who wasn't him. The registered owner of the company is "James Arnol Renner." (I note here that, like all claims in this case from social media accounts, the actual source of the J. Renner Inc. account is unknown.)

Reeves purchased a "fan card" which misspells her name and has some irregular capitalization.

Reeves spoke to an account ostensibly run by Renner's mother who said the other Jeremy Renner(s) were frauds but that her son wanted to talk to Reeves.

Reeves asserts that she had a video call with Jeremy Renner on August 28, 2023. The specific claim is, "Defendant was in his car driving to the store per the Plaintiff and Defendant's conversation, his phone was to the left of him, and he said, 'I just called to say hi and how are you doing today.' The video call was very clear and I could see him and a parking lot he was pulling into. He looked at me front view at least 3 times during the conversation. Plaintiff knew then she was safe to send the additional payments after August 2023."

Reeves engaged with a Renner as late as September 2025 and indicated she still wanted to pursue a relationship and alternatively that she was angry with him for his failures. She alleged to a Renner that he was fake because he did not know of this lawsuit.

This case was filed on December 13, 2024, and a demurrer was filed by Renner in February, 2025.

Renner's Claims

Renner filed a declaration saying that he never had the phone number attributable to many of the contacts with Reeves, he did not ask for any money from her, he did not receive any money from her, he did not have anything to do with any of the many social media accounts and emails that contacted Reeves, and that he was entirely disconnected with Reeves except for one meeting at a Sweet Grass Vodka event in which they had no substantive conversation.

Renner also provides evidence that he has attempted to deter fans from falling for romance scams.

Renner asserts incorrectly that no celebrity would charge money for a meet and greet. (See, for instance, <https://www.weirdal.com/vip-package-faqs/> (page accessed July 8, 2026.))

The Court also rejects Renner's conclusion that this was a single scammer or a single group of scammers.

Governing Law

A "party moving for summary judgment bears an initial burden of production to make a prima facie showing of the nonexistence of any triable issue of material fact" (Aguilar v. Atlantic Richfield Co. (2001) 25 Cal.4th 826, 850.) "A prima facie showing is one sufficient to support the position of the party in question." (Id. at p. 851.) A defendant meets their burden of showing that a cause of action has no merit if the party shows that "one or more elements of the cause of action, even if not separately pleaded, cannot be established, or that there is a complete defense to the cause of action." (Code Civ. Proc., § 437c(p)(2).) Once the defendant meets that burden, the burden shifts to the plaintiff, who must show that "a triable issue of one or more material facts exists as to the cause of action or a defense thereto." (Ibid.)

"Because of the drastic nature of the summary judgment procedure and the importance of safeguarding the adverse party's right to a trial, the moving party must make a strong showing. His affidavits are strictly construed and the opposing party's are liberally construed." (Garcia v. World Savings, FSB (2010) 183 Cal.App.4th 1031, 1038.) All doubts as to whether any material, triable issues of fact exist are to be resolved in favor of the party opposing summary judgment or adjudication. (Barber v. Marina Sailing, Inc. (1995) 36 Cal.App.4th 558, 562.) Thus, evidence that is equivocal or from which conflicting inferences may be drawn is insufficient to meet the movant's burden. (Anderson v. Metalclad Insulation Corp. (1999) 72 Cal.App.4th 284, 297.)

In addition to moving for summary judgment, "[a] party may move for summary adjudication as to one or more causes of action within an action, one or more affirmative defenses, one or more claims for damages, or one or more issues of duty, if that party contends that the cause of action has no merit or that there is no affirmative defense thereto, or that there is no

merit to an affirmative defense as to any cause of action, or both, or that there is no merit to a claim for damages, as specified in Section 3294 of the Civil Code, or that one or more defendants either owed or did not owe a duty to the plaintiff or plaintiffs.” (Code Civ. Proc., § 437c(f)(1).) A motion for summary adjudication proceeds in all procedural respects as a motion for summary judgment. (Code Civ. Proc., § 437c(f)(2).

Analysis

Renner has met the first hurdle. His clear disclaiming of any of the social media contacts and of any ownership of the emails, phone numbers, or businesses is sufficient to shift the burden to Reeves to show that the people she sent money to were Renner or agents of Renner.

Reeves clearly has competent evidence that she has made payments to multiple people and certainly has enough evidence that she intended to form a relationship with Renner.

But Reeves’ factual disputes are insufficient. In UMF’s 66-75, Renner disclaims any knowledge of the individuals Reeves sent money to – Julie Parsons, Mythe Thien Nguyen Dinh, Dorie Nichols, and Mle Michovska Mihaela. Reeves says Renner was aware of these people, but the basis for that is that Renner told her to send the money to these people, and in some cases there are tenuous connections to them via website or (assertedly) AI searches.

The web searches are not evidence, and the remainder is entirely speculative.

Reeves assert that she was contacted via many different phone numbers on WhatsApp. She cites the following text from August 1, 2025:

“I understand we talked before, then all of the sudden I could not access my telegram anymore, then by that time I gained full access to it, this whole stuff has already taken place, I was so confused. I do feel it’s some one in my circle.”

Reeves analysis is: “This is not how imposters act or say.” This analysis is not compelling.

Celebrities are not immune from committing crimes of all sorts. Renner’s celebrity status provides him no immunity from ordinary summary judgment analysis. Renner’s celebrity status does provide motive for scammers to imitate him though, and the manner in which this was done does not reflect a well-oiled entertainment management organization as Reeves alleges.

The phone call

Reeves asserts that she made a video phone call in which she saw the “front” of Renner three times in August, 2023. Under Code Civ. Proc. section 437c(e), the Court may not determine credibility unless the matter is so incredible as a matter of law as not to be believed.

Inferences from facts however may be made. I assume that the phone call occurred.

This was the linchpin allegation that brought this case past the demurrer stage. This was also the closest portion of this ruling, and I have carefully considered the allegation.

Reeves said Renner “looked” at her, implying but not directly asserting that she saw his face. But Reeves provides no evidence of control over the phone. The call, as described, has a driving “Renner” not viewable by Reeves except when he

looked at the phone three times while driving.

Even if she saw his face, the alleged ratification of prior contacts would very strongly indicate this was not the actual Jeremy Renner; I have tried to give the flavor of the contacts, and there are no remaining signs that the actual person Jeremy Renner had anything to do with any of this. Reeves also expressed doubts before and after the phone call, including months after Renner had appeared in this case. Reeves herself seems unpersuaded that this evidence was dispositive.

Further, in *People v. Schlimbach* (2011) 193 Cal.App.4th 1132, fn6, an appellate court found that the Court may determine as a matter of law that a factual assertion is not credible under unusual circumstances.

In that case, the assertion that a person with a 0.24% blood alcohol might appear to be intoxicated when he was not, and that another had a speech impediment which the officer mistook for being under the influence. This obviously is not impossible, but was of sufficiently remote probability that the appellate court found it to be facially incredible and that a trial court would be within its rights to ignore it.

Conclusion

There is virtually no evidence that Renner got the money or asked for the money, and the evidence is insufficient to tie him to the phone call. If this were a beyond-a-reasonable-doubt standard, Renner is not liable beyond a reasonable doubt, and probably by the higher standard of criminal factual innocence.

I note here that this case has used substantial resources of the court and counsel. I would caution the legislature not to impose a cure worse than the problem; this case has doubtless been vexing to Renner (and surely to Reeves, who appears to still believe the actor stole her money). Lawsuits against people who did nothing wrong are expensive and taxing; California's efforts to reduce them – as by anti-SLAPP rules – have been laudable.

The Court will sign the proposed order. Defendant is to prepare a judgment consistent with this ruling.